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Extension Program/ Project Title:	WOK to FORK: <i>Negosyo Tutukan, Consumidor Proteksyunan</i>
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Category:	Health and Environment

BACKGROUND

The World Health Organization (WHO) asserts that there are connections between food security, nutrition, and safety. Unsafe food contributes to a vicious cycle of sickness and hunger that disproportionately affects young children, the elderly, the sick, and infants. A safe food supply promotes national economies, trade, and tourism while also enhancing food and nutrition security and promoting sustainable development. The safety of food is impacted by factors such as the globalization of food trade, an expanding global population, climate change, and quickly evolving food systems. By doing this, the World Health Organization hopes to improve its ability to stop, identify, and address public health hazards brought on by hazardous food at both the international and national levels. Further, each year outbreaks of diarrhea caused by contaminated food and water affect around 2.2 million people worldwide. Food borne illnesses can also result in cancer, reactive arthritis, brain and neurological disorders, kidney and liver failure and diarrhea. As a result, food borne diseases must be thoroughly examined to avoid possible outbreaks (CDC,2011).

In the Municipality of Pontevedra, ambulant vendors are visible in all streets including outside schools. As observed, these ambulant vendors overlook the importance of safety and quality of the food they offer. As a result, negligence can cause food-related diseases and the worst scenario is contamination that might harm the customers, particularly the young people.

Street food is popular in developing economies because it offers individuals and families both employment and income. Growing poverty and unemployment are also critical factors in attracting individuals to the street food industry, which requires less capital (AddoTham et al., 2020). The sector is booming because it is generally inexpensive, readily available and provides wide array of choices of meals. However, food poisoning and other health risks associated with street food out-weight the benefits of buying a product.

The creation of a project entitled ***Wok to Fork: Negosyo Tutukan, Consumidor Proteksyunan*** will be introduced by KALAPIT Extension Banner under Kabuy-anan, Ikaayong Lawas kag Ihibalo. All food vendors and/or food handlers in the Municipality of Pontevedra who are properly registered and recognized as legitimate business including those ambulant vendors are required to attend and complete this training. The wok to fork method will focus on food preparation from WOK (Workers of the Kitchen) to FORK (service delivery to the table) of the consumers.

RATIONALE

Universal access to safe food is a key requirement for the 2030 Agenda for the Sustainable Development Goals. And yet an estimated 600 million people each year fall sick from eating unsafe food and 420 000 of them die. Safe food is also critical for economic development and the international food trade.

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According to Hassan (2020), the majority of vendors (59–70.9%) were found to have inadequate hygiene and sanitary standards, including food debris on their hands, unprotected hair, a lack of an apron, and inconsistent or non-existent handwashing with soap after using the restroom. Leonard W.T. Fweja (2020), explained that foodborne illness is a serious public health issue that has a negative impact on life expectancy, lower labor productivity, and medical expenses. It also lowers quality of life. Previous research shows that foodborne outbreaks rarely happen in reputable hotels and restaurants; instead, they usually result from consuming inexpensive food sold on the street that has been prepared with insufficient attention to proper food hygiene procedures. Similar opinions suggest that one of the main concerns with foods sold on the street is still food safety. They linked the unsafe preparation and sale of street food to unhygienic conditions, as well as a lack of access to potable water and sanitary or waste disposal services. Research suggests that lowering the risk of foodborne illnesses depends not only on food professionals maintaining appropriate food hygiene practices, but also on how customers and food handlers behave when obtaining food and how they feel about food safety and hygiene when preparing food.

Recently, the country's policy framework and operation standards for food sanitation and hygiene practices continuously improving. Due to the growing incidence of food-borne diseases and malnutrition globally, hygiene and sanitation have recently received more attention. Despite food regulation policies, the local government unit have no restrictions about regulating the laws and ordinances. Inadequate safety, hygiene and sanitation problems remain in the area.

Further, there is no arguing that street food vendors help resolve significant economic and social difficulties in the nation by offering prepared meals at reasonable prices and creating jobs for many rural and urban residents throughout its supply chain. However, due to its informal nature of the business, the vendors activities are not controlled. As a result, unwholesome practices can flourish. For this very reason, the WOK to Fork Project will be introduced to promote sanitary practices of ambulant vendors in the Municipality of Pontevedra.

With the above premise, it is important to examine the hygiene and sanitary practices of ambulant vendors in the Municipality of Pontevedra to inform appropriate actions that can be undertaken by the rural health unit and local government officials to make sure that the food we eat, enjoy and take outs from the streets are safe for human consumption. It will also provide information to the Sangguniang Bayan Members to develop an ordinance and programs in order to enhance the hygiene and sanitary practices of ambulant vendors and also regulate some laws pertaining to food safety.

The Project WOK to FORK Project is created to focus on food safety that will help in achieving one Health Vision of Sustainable Development Goals under the following, to wit;

SDG 2. Zero Hunger: Food Security entails food safety and it cannot be attained if the food is not safe and may destroy food availability.

SDG 3. Good Health and Well-being: Production, processing and consumption of food is also associated with diseases, and the associated health, psychological and economic burdens. These include exposure of agri-food sector workers to occupational hazards (e.g. pesticides or pathogens) as well as diseases associated with agriculture (e.g. antimicrobial resistant pathogens resulting from use of antimicrobials in food animals and pandemics emerging from intensively kept, genetically similar livestock).

SDG 6. Clean Water & Sanitation: Lack of clean water for washing food and food equipment and for food handler hygiene increases the risk of food being unsafe

GOALS AND OBJECTIVES

The wok to fork project is expected to be adopted and will be strengthened through an ordinance of the Sangguniang Bayan in the Municipality of Pontevedra. This will allow the food vendors to obtain a certificate that will accredit them as safe food handlers. A food handler is anyone who, through their work activity, has direct contact with food during any of its phases until it reaches the final consumer. The certificate should be renewed annually, and before it can be issued, the recipient must complete the training in food safety, safe food handling and waste management so that they are up to date on the latest trends and best practices in food delivery and service.

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It is crucial that we recognize the significant role we play in the prevention because, most of the time, the person handling the food acts as the path of transmission for these diseases. The objectives of this training are as follows:

1. Create awareness and compliance to all ambulant vendors about RA 10611 (Food Safety Act of 2013), RA 9003 (Solid Waste Management Act 2000) adhering to standards, regulations and statutory requirements of the government
2. To provide knowledge and skills about wok to fork methods (food preparation & service) adhering to service quality for consumer protection.
3. To provide knowledge how to reinvent food wastes into sustainable waste materials.
4. To increase food registration and health permit releasing for vendors in the municipality
5. To intensify and institutionalize food safety campaign and monitoring through established Municipal Ordinance requiring all ambulant vendors to register and participate the WOK to FORK Training annually.

PROJECT DESCRIPTION

The WOK to FORK project will intensify campaign about food safety, waste management and disposal in order to ensure safe and nutritious food alongside of the roads. This project is in partnership with the CapSU- CESO, Department of Health, Rural Sanitary Unit, LGU-Pontevedra. This is a collaborative projects with the involvement of internal (CapSU) and external (LGU) experts that will train all ambulant vendors in the area. This project is expected to come up with a municipal ordinance to require all food handlers to undergo training before the release of their permits and or health cards.

The unsanitary handling of street foods in Pontevedra has been commonly found to be the source of contamination. The vendors can be carriers of pathogens like *Escherichia coli*, *Salmonella*, *Shigella*, *Campylobacter* and *S. aureus* who eventually transfer these food borne hazards to the consumers. Street vended foods are not only liked by the public for their tasty flavors, but also because of their cheap price, availability, and accessibility. These street foods are also liked by the school children because they are not just delicious but also cheap and easy to find. School children are found to be the important consumers of street food and most of them eat street food every day (Poster, 1983; Chauliac et al., 1994; Webb & Hyatt, 1998).

In spite of the importance of nutrition value, taste, and affordability of the street food, they are mostly criticized because vendors do not normally follow personal, food and environmental safety and hygiene (Selepe et al., 2017; Joglekar, 2013). Without proper and safe personal and food hygiene, these foods could be contaminated by microorganisms. Street vended foods can cause foodborne diseases such as diarrhea and food poisoning (Sofos, 2013). The leading cause of death in children is a diarrheal disease and it is causing more than 1,400 childhood deaths per day worldwide and about 526,000 childhood deaths per year (WHO, 2015). Though there is a dearth of data focusing on the health risks of street food in school areas, still school children are at risk of these foodborne diseases.

Regulating street vendors operating in the streets and in the school is a must to avoid such incidents. In order to prevent possible food contamination, proper food handling and storage for better sanitary and hygienic control must be observed (Barcelon et. al, 2015). Although there is an existing act to strengthen the food safety regulatory system in the country (Republic Act No. 10611), it is obvious that the government does not have full management of the local food and food products. The missing pieces of the management are close monitoring and evaluation of the foods sold locally and a strict food safety regulatory system. The incidents of food poisoning and lack of management of the government of the street foods are issues concerning the health safety of the school children and the public. For instance, Rustia et al. (2021) cited the identified gap in the concept of food safety in the street food industry and ambulant vendors in the country was generally influenced by the practice of a vendor compromising food safety for business profits. With this food handling issues, Van Olem and Olmogues (2021) recommend local government constant monitoring on these street food vendors to strengthen food safety practices as these vendors serve different types of consumers.

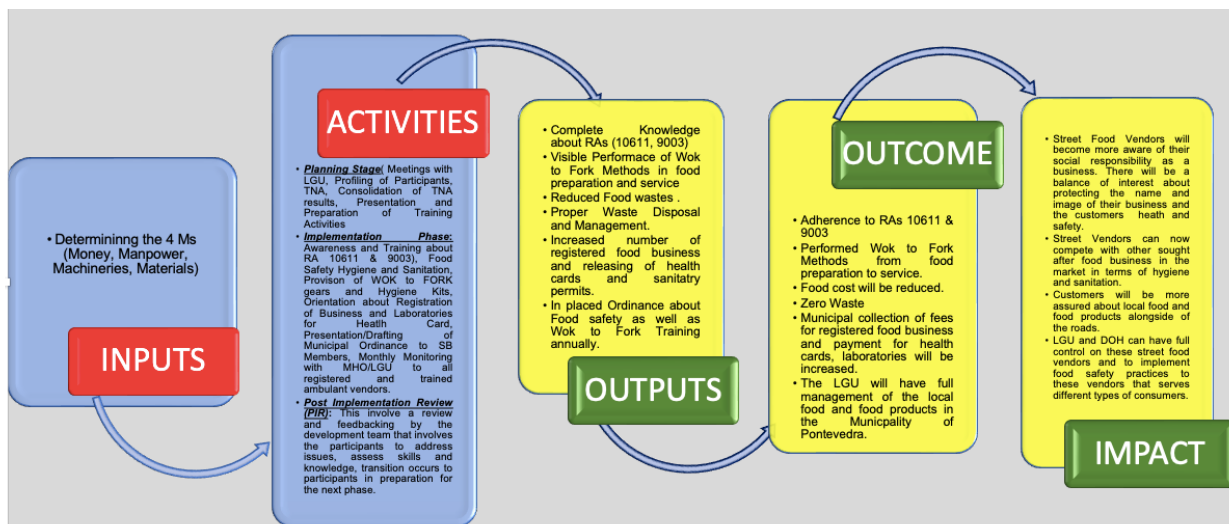
Further, the WOK to FORK project will become the center for Food Safety, Hygiene,

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Sanitation and Waste Management training provider to ensure that these food vendors, workers of the kitchen (WOK) will adhere to standards and regulatory requirements in food preparation and waste management disposal to protect the public health and make their business become safe, profitable and competitive.

The Result Chain Framework

This display will guide us to the entire duration of the project and what are the necessary things to prepare and accomplish at the end of its training period.



PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION

A.1. Monitoring & Evaluation System

ACTIVITIES	Process of Implementation	LEAD/ACTORS	TARGET DATE OF IMPLEMENTATION	LOCATION
A. <u>Project Initiation Phase (PIP)</u> - Data Gathering and Project Planning/Conceptualization - Formulation of Project Purpose, Goals and Objectives. - Identification of Teams and Experts - Drafting of Activities for the Project using 4 Ms.	- External Assessment and document reviews of researches related to Food Safety and regulations. - Consultation with internal experts. - Identification of beneficiaries and or partner agencies.	-Project Proponent Members/Experts	2 nd Week of February 2024	CapSU Pontevedra/ MHO-LGU
B. <u>Planning Phase (PP)</u> - Meeting & Consultation with Partner Agencies (MHO, LGU, SB for Health) - Presentation of Planned Activities, Purpose, Goals and Objectives.	- Courtesy Call (Meeting) of LGU Pontevedra, MHO, RSI and SB In-charge for Health and Legal Counsel. - Briefing sessions and presentation of Project to identified partners. - Identification of resources and	-CapSU Project Proponents LGU (MHO, RSI, SB for Health & Legal Counsel)	3 rd Week of February 2024	LGU- Municipal Hall

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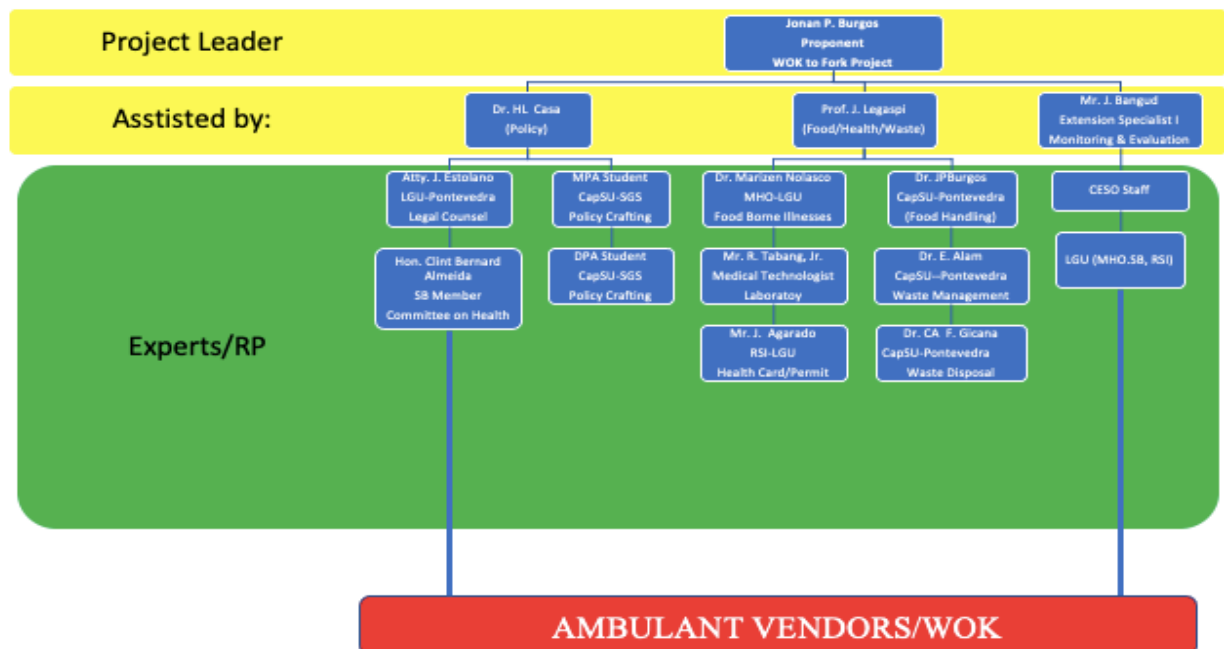
	counterparts both for LGU & CapSU.			
C. Project Pre- Execution Phase (PPEP) - Conduct Beneficiaries Profiling based on the identified lists of the Rural Sanitary Inspector of the Municipal Health Offices - Information and invites to the target beneficiaries and Experts.	- Survey Data about beneficiaries Profile - Distribution of Invitation letter about the conduct of the training to the beneficiaries and experts.	CapSU Project Proponents LGU (MHO, RSI)	Last Week of February 2024	Municipality of Pontevedra Street Vendors location
d. Project Execution Phase (PEP) - Conduct Training about RAs (10611 & 9003), Food Hygiene and Sanitation and Waste Management and provision of Hygiene Kit (Gears). - Conduct Pre-Test & Post Test - Distribution of TNA. - Conduct Trainings based on TNA Results. - Organization of Ambulant Vendors in the Municipality of Pontevedra as WOK (Workers of the Kitchen).	- Submit training proposal and Conduct Training about Wok to Fork to in relation to RA 10611 and 9003 to all Ambulant Vendors in the Municipality of Pontevedra - Provide knowledge and salient Features of Food Safety Act and Solid Waste Management - Provide Guidance in the registration of ambulant vendors including the application for health permits and laboratories to LGU- Pontevedra. - Conduct of Training Need Assessment basis for targeted activities and additional training. - Formed group of WOK Association in the Pontevedra to discuss issues and problems about their business.	CapSU Project Proponents LGU (MHO, RSI) Experts, Beneficiaries	March 2024 to June 2026	Mar Hall- Pontevedra
e. Project Monitoring & Control (PMC) - Monitoring and Feedbacking	- Regular and actual monitoring of the ambulant vendors food safety practices and service. - Scheduled Meeting to all ambulant Vendors through the Office of the SB for Health and LGU-Pontevedra. - Discuss issues and concerns. - Recording and documentation of the event/meetings.	CapSU Project Proponents LGU (MHO, RSI) Beneficiaries	June 2024 to December 2026	Mar Hall- Pontevedra

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A.2. Gantt Chart

Activities	SCHEDULE OF ACTIVITIES											
	2024				2025				2026			
	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
a. <u>Project Initiation Phase (PIP)</u>												
b. <u>Planning Phase (PP)</u>												
c. <u>Project Pre-Execution Phase (PEP)</u>												
d. <u>Project Execution Phase (PEP)</u>												
e. <u>Project Monitoring & Control (PMC)</u>												

B. Project Management Team: *The WOK to Fork Project will be composed of the following:*



C. Monitoring and Evaluation Scheme

In order to carry out all the tasks, objectives and purpose of this project it is very important to monitor, evaluate and reports issues and concerns related to all activities implemented. This is to ensure how intervention evolves over time and how effectively the program was implemented and whether there are gaps between planned and achieved results and whether the changes in well-being of the beneficiaries impacted the most of their lives. It is suggested that there will be a monthly/quarterly monitoring together with the help of LGU-Pontevedra Rural Sanitary Inspectors and CapSU Pontevedra Team to strengthen food safety practices of ambulant vendors as these vendors serve different types of consumers every day and to ensure that these food vendors, workers of the kitchen (WOK) adhere

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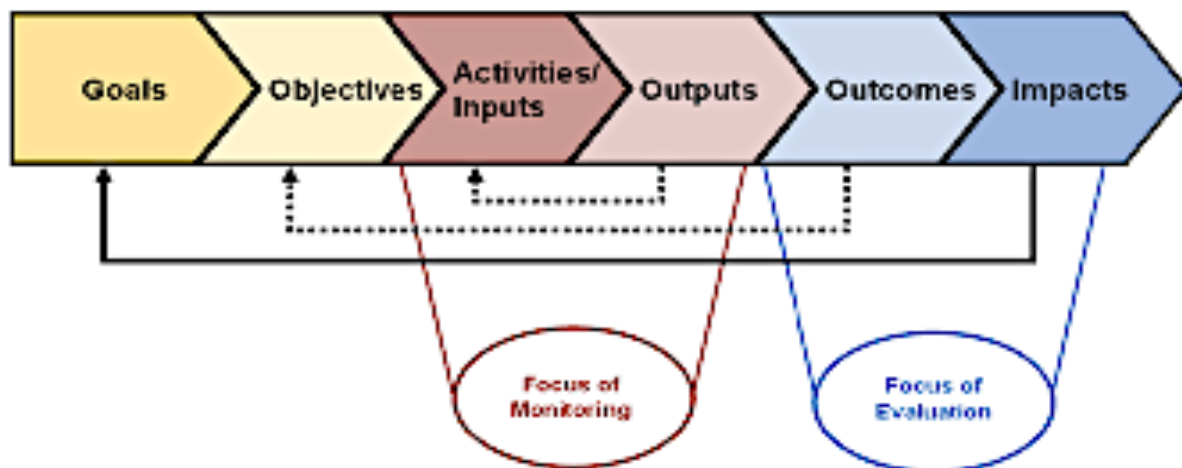
to standards and regulatory requirements in food preparation and waste management disposal to protect the public health.

Based on the diagram, the Monitoring and Evaluation Scheme will highlight results on the following:

1. The Monitoring will focus on outputs results versus inputs.
2. The evaluation will focus on Impacts and outcomes.

On the other hand, outcome results should be in the basis of the objectives set as quantifiable. However, the outputs will be based on the Activities or inputs of the project established. Further, the impacts can be measured through the achievement of achievable goals of the projects as over-all results whether the project is impactful, beneficial and has a positive results to the lives of the beneficiaries and communities as a whole.

A. Monitoring & Evaluation Framework



Data Collection Plan

Extension Program/Project Title: WOK to FORK: Negosyo Tutukan, Consumidor Proteksyunan					
Goal: To educate and institutionalize food safety practices among ambulant vendors and adheres to government laws to prevent foodborne illnesses related to food consumption for the consumers protection.					
Objectives:					
1. Create awareness and compliance to all ambulant vendors about RA 10611 (Food Safety Act of 2013), RA 9003 (Solid Waste Management Act 2000) adhering to standards, regulations and statutory requirements of the government 2. To provide knowledge and skills about wok to fork methods (food preparation & service) adhering to service quality for consumer protection. 3. To provide knowledge how to reinvent food wastes into sustainable waste materials. 4. To increase food registration and health permit releasing to all ambulant vendors in the municipality 5. To intensify and institutionalize food safety campaign and monitoring through Municipal Ordinance requiring all ambulant vendors to registered and participate the WOK to FORK Training annually.					
Persons Involve	Information Needed	Assigned Person	Schedule/ Frequency of Monitoring	Activities/ Process/ Methods	Verifiable Evidences
Ambulant Vendors	-Awareness & Compliance Level on RA 10611 & 9003 - Behavior/Practices towards food safety (Wok to Fork Methods)	- CapSU Team MHO-RSI	Monthly/Quarterly	Interviews and Personal Observations	-Sales Records -M&E Forms verified and signed. -Photos

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	-Sales reports/financial status and issues encountered.				
	Progress Report	- CapSU Team MHO-RSI	After the training conducted.	Interviews and Personal Observations	- Outcome evaluation report.
	Impact Assessment	CapSU Team MHO-RSI - 3 rd Party	After the project/terminated.	Interviews and Personal Observations and validation.	- Impact Assessment Report
CapSU & LGU Teams	-Ordinance Implementation and Monitoring -Increased and Updated registration of the ambulant vendors in the municipali	CapSU and LGU Teams	Whole duration	-LGU and CapSU closed coordination and communication and constant feedbacking	-Approved Local Ordinance about Food Safety -Institutionalize Training about Food Safety through Wok to Fork Project

SUSTAINABILITY PLAN

To sustain the project, the following 4 Ps of Project sustainability will be implemented and maintained:



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RESOURCE REQUIREMENTS

Budgetary requirements will be shared by both institutions: CapSU Pontevedra and LGU Pontevedra.

Nature	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	
Meals and Snacks during Training and other activities (<i>Lunch for Facilitator & Speaker, Snacks for Participants</i>):	195,000.00	234,000.00	280,800.00	709,800.00
Training Materials (and Starter Kits during Livelihood Training)	100,000.00	120,000.00	144,000.00	364,000.00
Token for Speakers	10,000.00	12,000.00	14,400.00	36,400.00
Total	305,000.000	366,000.00	439,200.00	<u>1,110,200.00</u>

Note: A buffer of 20% per year from the budget with 50 participants per 10 training.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The creation of a project entitled ***Wok to Fork: Negosyo Tutukan, Consumidor Proteksyunan*** will be introduced by KALAPIT Extension Banner under Kabuy-anan, Ikaayong Lawas kag Ihibalo. All food vendors and/or food handlers in the Municipality of Pontevedra who are properly registered and recognized as legitimate business including those ambulant vendors are required to attend and complete this training. The wok to fork method will focus on food preparation (from wok/kitchen/people) and service delivery (from fork to mouth) of the consumers.

The wok to fork project will be strengthened through an ordinance of the Sangguniang Bayan in the Municipality of Pontevedra. This will allow the food vendors to obtain a certificate that will accredit them as safe food handlers. As defined, a food handler is anyone who, through their work activity, has direct contact with food during any of its phases until it reaches the final consumer. The certificate should be renewed annually, and before it can be issued, the recipient must complete the training in food safety, safe food handling and waste management so that they are up to date on the latest trends and best practices in food delivery and service.

It is crucial that we recognize the significant role we play in the prevention because, most of the time, the person handling the food acts as the path of transmission for these diseases. The advantages of this training are as follows:

1. Reducing business spoiled product costs.
2. Well-trained employees adhering to standards, regulations and statutory requirements.
3. Improve company reputation.
4. Perform wok to fork method (food preparation & service) adhering to service quality.
5. Develop mechanisms to reinvent food wastes into sustainable waste materials.

After completing this program, it is anticipated that all food vendors will adhere to RA 10611 and RA 9003 legislative requirements for food safety, waste management and disposal. Additionally, a Sangguniang Bayan Member will enact an ordinance under the health program mandating that all food handlers should undergo and complete this type of training before receiving their health card, permit, or certificate or its equivalent.

The activity is in partnership with the College of Management, College of Education, College of Agriculture, LGU-Pontevedra, and DOH-Rural Health Unit.

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